

interface is a cool grey, with the normal division of the workspace into a composer pane, timeline and bin. What would really hit you hard is the complexity of the menu system, which is quite different from your conventional menus. The most notable feature is the missing 'View' tab. So if you want to change the layout, you'd have to do a bit of hunting around. The exhaustive Help file also gets to you at times.

This freeware offers 16 customisable real-time effects, drag and drop editing, three-point editing, basic compositing effects, filters and YUV rendering. The software also has a titling tool and an encoding tool that can encode files into the QuickTime (.mov) format. Input options include the DV FireWire option for quick transfer of data from your digital or analogue DV camera to the computer. Compared to the Professional and Express versions of the software, Avid Free DV seems like a very basic tool, but when up against the best free editing suites around - or even ones like AVS Video Editor - it comes out trumps.

After registering the software on the Web site, you become part of the Avid community, and can access their forums and online tutorials. The tool takes a bit of time to learn, but the results are worth the effort and time.

4.5.3 VirtualDubMod

VirtualDubMod is an open source video processing software. It was a result of a number of modifications to the original VirtualDub. These modifications were merged into one simple application to make life easy for people who got tired of needing several different modified VirtualDub executables. In an improvement over the earlier VirtualDub, VirtualDubMod offers basic Unicode support. However, this support is only available in Windows versions that handle it natively, such as Win2k and XP. The earlier versions of Windows did not handle this.

Unlike WMM2, VirtualDubMod is a linear processing software where the entire movie file is treated as one object - and not as a